

INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF

Enterprise Service Lead | GDIT supporting U.S. Customs and Border Protection

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EXECUTIVE THESIS

Move intelligence at mission speed. Keep every decision defensible. The Enterprise Services Lead should create the connective tissue that turns cloud, data, graph, and AI investments into analyst-facing services that can cross security, governance, adoption, and operational-readiness boundaries.

ACTUAL MANDATE

Build and lead a cross-functional enterprise-services capability that translates operational questions into scalable, explainable, secure services synchronized to the Cloud Migration sequence: environment assessment, platform selection, design and architecture, provisioning and data migration, and reporting transition.

OPERATING TENSIONS

- Innovation speed vs. security, lineage, and compliance.
- Enterprise reference architecture vs. analyst workflow specificity.
- AI/ML ambition vs. explainability and human decision authority.
- Rapid prototyping vs. production integration and sustainable ownership.
- Cross-domain data access vs. minimum-necessary exposure and defensible controls.

CROSS-DOMAIN SERVICE AIRLOCK

1

MISSION QUESTION

Define the operational decision and accountable owner.

2

DATA & PLATFORM

Validate source, access, lineage, quality, and platform fit.

3

MODEL & SERVICE

Prototype the graph, analytics, automation, or AI service.

4

TRUST GATE

Prove explainability, security, testing, operator readiness, and recovery.

5

MISSION RELEASE

Transition reporting, ownership, feedback, and continuous learning.

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EVIDENCE MAP

Vape-Jet	AI-first operating transformation across factory, field, customer, machine, quality, ERP, support, and engineering signals.
DudeWorth	AI-readiness, agentic workflow, human-review, governance, evaluation, and adoption frameworks.
Amazon	24/7 mission-critical operating mechanisms, visibility, escalation, standard work, Lean, and Gemba at scale.
Compunetics	High-reliability engineering, quality systems, technical programs, and DoD-adjacent stakeholder environments.
ZeusVu	Regulated autonomous systems, computer-vision concepts, chain of custody, and a 100% safety record with no FAA incidents.

STRONGEST OBJECTION AND RESPONSE

Objection: Russell does not claim previous CBP OIT support, an active CBP badge, or direct knowledge of undisclosed CBP processes. Response: his transferable advantage is repeatedly entering complex, regulated, high-consequence systems; learning the real workflow from operators and experts; and building governance, visibility, feedback, and adoption mechanisms that turn emerging technology into durable operating capability.

EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

- Which analyst decisions are most constrained today by data access, lineage, latency, or explainability?
- Where do prototypes most often stall between the Cross-Domain Working Group and enterprise operations?
- Which Cloud Migration wave gates create the largest capability or ownership ambiguity?
- What evidence does CBP leadership require before an AI/ML capability is trusted for operational use?
- How are model feedback, analyst correction, lineage, and retirement decisions governed today?
- What would make this role unquestionably successful after twelve months?

PUBLIC SOURCE GROUNDING

GDIT VIA strategy announcement (March 10, 2026); GDIT Artificial Intelligence capability page; GDIT Border Security capability page; GDIT Workday posting RQ217466-1; candidate evidence verified in supplied career record.